

The aftermath

The Government swung into action and within a month, more than 40 HRA members were arrested. Of these, 29 were put on trial, which lasted for more than two years. Eventually, all except four were sent to jail. Ramprasad Bismil, Ashfaqullah Khan, Roshan Singh, and Rajendra Nath Lahiri, were sentenced to death. Chandrashekhar Azad was never caught and died in a police encounter in 1931. The arrests and hangings ensured that the Kakori incident assumed almost mythic proportions, leaving a deep impact on the people of India. The capital punishment was seen, by some, as a disproportionate response and seemingly inspired yet more revolutionaries.



▲ **The Mauser C/96** was a preferred weapon for many revolutionaries, including Chandrashekhar Azad. This semi-automatic pistol was made in Germany in 1896–1937. Many unlicensed versions of it were manufactured in China. Reportedly, some of these were acquired and used by the Indian radicals.